

Clinton Ngotta

Chief Technology Officer | Full-Stack Software Engineer | Cloud and AI Engineering Leader

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Chief Technology Officer and Full-Stack Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience building secure, scalable, high-performance systems in fintech, logistics, edtech, and gaming. Builds with Node.js, Django, Spring Boot (Kotlin), React, Next.js, and Angular. Architects and runs production cloud infrastructure on AWS. Strong in DevOps, REST API design, and database engineering. Uses AI-augmented engineering daily, including RAG, LangChain, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Gemini CLI. Has led engineering teams of 8+, launched multi-national platforms, and delivered measurable gains in performance, cost, and user growth.

CORE SKILLS

Languages and Frameworks: JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Django, FastAPI, Node.js, Express, React, Next.js, React Native, Redux Toolkit, Angular, Ionic, PHP, Laravel, CodeIgniter, Spring Boot, Kotlin, jQuery, Tailwind CSS

AI Engineering: Claude Code (Certified), RAG, LangChain, Ollama (local LLMs), Gemini CLI, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, CodeRabbit, Kiro, Lovable, Antigravity, Agentic Workflows, AI-Assisted Code Review

Cloud and DevOps: AWS, Microsoft Azure, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Git, Linux, Firebase

Databases: MySQL, MariaDB, MongoDB, Redis, SQL

Leadership and Delivery: Engineering Leadership, CTO, Technical Strategy, System Architecture, Code Review, Agile, Scrum, FDD, Jira, GitHub Projects, Power BI, Mentoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Officer

SDC Startup School | Abuja, Nigeria | Apr 2026 - Present

Promoted from Tech Team Lead to lead all technology across the organization.

- Own all technology decisions, infrastructure, and the product roadmap for SDC OS.
- Lead, develop, and manage all technology associates.
- Build and maintain the data infrastructure and pipelines that feed SDC OS and the Research pillar.
- Designed SDC OS as a partner-deployable platform with reusable production modules, enabling fast partner onboarding from spec sign-off.
- Run code reviews and quality control to sustain 99% uptime and support 5,000+ concurrent users.

Tech Team Lead

SDC Startup School | Abuja, Nigeria | May 2025 - Apr 2026

- Led end-to-end design, development, deployment, and maintenance of software systems at sdcstartupschool.com, including a custom LMS and the website redesign for the first rebrand.
- Provisioned and administered production AWS infrastructure with high availability, security, and scalability.
- Rolled out and maintained ICT infrastructure for secure, reliable operations across staff and programs.
- Coached the technology team, raising capacity in ICT service delivery and technical operations.

Co-founder and Chief Technology Officer

Optimax Global Learning Ltd (startup) | Abuja, Nigeria | Jan 2026 - Present

- Architect and lead development of the full product platform at optimaxgll.com, covering learning management, content delivery, and user administration.
- Set technical strategy, stack selection, and infrastructure design for scalable global learning delivery.
- Provisioned and operate production AWS infrastructure focused on uptime, security, and cost efficiency.
- Direct a cross-functional team across engineering, content, and product to ship in short iterations.
- Integrate AI features that improve the learner experience and automate operational workflows.

Tech Trainer

Institute of Advanced Technology (IAT) | Nairobi, Kenya | Aug 2025 - Mar 2026

- Taught CompTIA A+ certification courses covering hardware, networking, operating systems, troubleshooting, security, and IT service management.
- Taught software engineering classes in JavaScript, Python, React, and Tailwind CSS, preparing students for full-stack development roles.

Senior Software Engineer and Team Lead

RFCG East Africa Ltd | Nairobi, Kenya | Aug 2024 - Mar 2025

- Led an 8-person engineering team using Scrum and FDD with Jira and GitHub Projects, improving delivery efficiency by 25%.
- Launched two multi-national gaming platforms, growing the user base by 50% within six months.
- Built and optimized RESTful APIs in Django and Node.js, improving system performance by 30%.

- Integrated payment gateways including M-Pesa, card payments, and bank SDKs (Chapa, ArifPay, SantimPay).
- Led frontend work in Next.js, Redux Toolkit, and Firebase, increasing user engagement by 30% and cutting page load times by 20%.
- Streamlined AWS deployments with the DevOps team, reducing deployment time by 40% and infrastructure cost by 15%.

ICT Team Lead

Ufanisi Freighters (K) Ltd | Mombasa, Kenya | Mar 2024 - Aug 2024

- Optimized ICT operations across three sister companies, improving efficiency by 20% and reducing system downtime by 10%. Established a business continuity plan and data protection measures.
- Led the migration from on-premises servers to AWS, cutting operating costs by 20% and improving performance and uptime.
- Built shipment management and tracking applications in Node.js, Angular, React, and Spring Boot (Kotlin) on AWS, covering cargo manifests, invoicing, delivery tracking, fleet and driver management, and reporting.
- Built analytics dashboards that gave stakeholders real-time visibility into freight operations and eliminated 100 hours of manual reporting per month.
- Led a cross-functional ICT team of 8+, mentored 10+ interns, and ran digital marketing campaigns that increased brand awareness by 20% and online sales by 30%.

ICT Officer and System Developer

Ufanisi Freighters (K) Ltd | Mombasa, Kenya | Aug 2022 - Mar 2024

- Built multiple custom systems from scratch for clearing and forwarding, transport, and logistics, improving operational efficiency by 30% and reducing data retrieval time by 40%.
- Managed and improved critical systems including websites, accounting, payroll, HRMS, and digital business cards, increasing data processing speed by 30%.
- Managed servers, networks, systems, and databases for 3 companies across different regions, improving uptime, and integrated M-Pesa and card payment gateways.
- Analyzed existing procedures and removed major inefficiencies, improving workflows and team collaboration.

System Developer and Maintainer

iTravel Holidays | Leicester, UK | Sep 2018 - Aug 2022

- Built and launched 3 booking systems (B2B, B2C, and agent) in PHP and React.js, improving booking efficiency by 40%.
- Built a C2B hotel reservation platform that increased user bookings by 25%.
- Built transfer and activity booking sub-systems that raised customer satisfaction by 20%, and a custom CRM that improved customer care delivery by 30%.
- Integrated UK banking SDKs with Ingenico WorldPay.

Software Developer

Splendid Media | Mombasa, Kenya | Mar 2020 - Present

- Built 15+ client websites in WordPress, HTML, CSS, PHP, React.js, and Next.js, increasing client engagement by 35%.

PROJECTS

- **Moyoma** (in progress): Offline-first React Native and Firebase app with newborn care guidance, postpartum support, and daily checklists for mothers and caregivers.
- **Psallm** (psallm.ng): Full-stack marketplace for buying and selling used products, with admin, buyer, and seller roles.
- **African Gender and Media Initiative** (gem.or.ke): Digital platform for an NGO that supports community engagement.
- **GCE Consulting** (gceconsulting.net): Corporate website that improved service visibility.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology, Second Class Honours

Technical University of Mombasa | Mombasa, Kenya | Sep 2013 - Dec 2018

CERTIFICATIONS

- Claude Code in Action, Anthropic (Mar 2026)
- AI Fluency: Framework and Foundations, Anthropic (Apr 2026)
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (Jul 2020)
- ISO 9001:2015 and ISO 22000:2018 Internal Auditors Course, Ideal Quality Solutions Limited (Mar 2023)
- LinkedIn Learning: DevOps with AWS | AWS for Developers: S3 | Building RESTful APIs with Node.js and Express | Learning REST APIs | Succeeding in DevOps | SQL: Data Reporting and Analysis | React: Testing and Debugging | Vue.js 2 Essential Training | Linux: Overview and Installation | Advanced Laravel

VOLUNTEERING

Software Engineering Mentor

Moringa School | Nairobi, Kenya | Mar 2025 - Present

- Guide students from non-technical backgrounds into software engineering through tech talks, career goal setting, structured learning plans, and ATS resume and LinkedIn reviews.